

BM2005 LU1 – Fundamentals of Entrepreneurship

Case Study Worksheet

Section A: Understanding the Idea

Product Name	
Describe the product in your own words.	
What problem does this product solve?	
Who experiences this problem? (Target users)	

Section B: Problem–Solution Fit

How serious is the problem? (Low / Medium / High)	
What existing solutions are available?	
Why is this product better than existing solutions?	
Is this a “must-have” or “nice-to-have” product? Why?	

Section C: Value Proposition

Complete the sentence:

“This product helps _____ (target user) to _____ (solve problem) by _____ (unique benefit).”

Section D: Business Model Thinking

1. How will the business make money?

- ☐ **Subscription**
- ☐ **One-time purchase**
- ☐ **Freemium**
- ☐ **Advertising**
- ☐ **Other:** _____

2. What are the major costs?

- **Development**
- **Manufacturing**
- **Marketing**
- **Others:** _____

Section E: Market Analysis

Who are the target customers?	
Is this a growing market? Why	
Name at least 2 competitors	
What is your competitive advantage?	

Section F: Risks Assessment

What are the potential risks?	
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Case 1: AI Study Companion

Scenario:

Students struggle with personalized learning. A startup builds an AI tutor that adapts to each student's pace and curriculum.

Guiding Questions:

- Will students rely too much on AI?
- Should schools adopt or ban it?
- How can it be monetized (students vs schools)?

A. Understanding the Idea

- Product: AI-powered personalized learning assistant
- Problem: Students struggle with different learning speeds and lack personalized support
- Target Users: Secondary school, tertiary students, and lifelong learners

B. Problem–Solution Fit

- **Problem Severity:** High
- **Existing Solutions:** Tuition centres, YouTube, e-learning platforms
- **Why Better:**
 - Instant feedback
 - Personalized learning path
 - Available 24/7

Conclusion: Must-have (especially in competitive education systems)

C. Value Proposition

Helps students improve learning efficiency by providing personalized AI tutoring anytime.

D. Business Model

- Freemium model (basic free, premium features paid)
- Institutional licensing to schools

Costs:

- AI development

- Cloud infrastructure
- Content creation

E. Market Analysis

- **Customers:** Students, parents, schools
- **Market Trend:** Growing EdTech demand
- **Competitors:** Online learning platforms, tutoring centres
- **Advantage:** Real-time personalization

F. Risks

- Over-reliance on AI
- Data privacy concerns
- Accuracy of explanations

Case 2: Smart Indoor Farming Pods

Scenario:

Urban households face limited space and rising food costs. A startup proposes AI-powered indoor farming pods that allow users to grow fresh produce at home.

Guiding Questions:

- Is this practical in small apartments (e.g., Singapore context)?
- Would consumers adopt this habit?
- What pricing strategy would work?
- Is this a lifestyle product or necessity?

A. Understanding the Idea

- **Problem:** Limited space and access to fresh produce in urban areas
- **Target Users:** Urban households, eco-conscious consumers

B. Problem–Solution Fit

- Severity: Medium
- Existing Solutions: Supermarkets, traditional gardening
- Why Better:
 - Fresh, pesticide-free food
 - Convenient and automated

Conclusion: Nice-to-have (not essential for all households)

C. Value Proposition

Enables urban residents to grow fresh food easily at home using AI automation.

D. Business Model

- Hardware sales + subscription for seeds/nutrients

Costs:

- Manufacturing
- Logistics
- R&D

E. Market Analysis

- Customers: Middle- to high-income households
- Trend: Sustainability and self-sufficiency
- Competitors: Hydroponic kits
- Advantage: Fully automated system

F. Risks Assessment

- High upfront cost
- Low adoption due to habit change

START-UP PITCH TEMPLATE

Start-Up Name	
Target Customers	
Problem Statement	
Solution	
Unique Value Propositions	
Market Opportunity	
Key Risks	
Closing Statement	

Activity: “What Type Am I?” – Scenario Bank

Easy Level (Clear Clues)

1. A startup creates a new AI tool that predicts student exam results accurately
2. A business launches a cheaper version of an existing ride-hailing app
3. A company employee develops a new internal chatbot for HR questions
4. A startup builds low-cost water filters for rural villages
5. A founder invents a smart mirror that gives health advice
6. A café copies Starbucks’ model but focuses on local desserts
7. An employee redesigns the company’s inventory system to reduce waste
8. A business creates solar-powered lamps for communities without electricity

Moderate Level (Requires Thinking)

9. A startup improves food delivery apps by adding AI-based meal recommendations
10. A founder creates a platform to connect volunteers with elderly people in need
11. A company team develops a new digital payment system for internal use
12. A business copies an e-learning platform but adds gamification features
13. A startup develops a completely new way to charge devices wirelessly across rooms
14. A company employee proposes a paperless workflow system
15. A startup sells affordable refurbished laptops to low-income students
16. A fashion brand replicates luxury designs but sells them at lower prices

Challenging Level (Tricky / Hybrid Thinking)

17. A startup creates an app similar to Uber but focuses on transport for disabled users
18. A company launches a new AI-powered recruitment system internally
19. A founder introduces a new biodegradable material to replace plastic packaging
20. A business copies a fitness app but targets corporate employees only
21. A startup builds a platform to redistribute excess food from restaurants

- 22. An employee develops a new customer feedback analytics tool within the company
- 23. A startup enhances existing online shopping by adding virtual try-on using AR
- 24. A company creates a green initiative system to track carbon emissions internally

Advanced Level (Ambiguous / Discussion-Based)

- 25. A startup copies a food delivery model but donates 1 meal for every order placed
- 26. A founder creates a new cryptocurrency for social impact funding
- 27. A company employee introduces a new product line using company resources
- 28. A startup develops an app similar to Airbnb but focuses on eco-friendly stays
- 29. A business improves existing tutoring platforms with AI tutors for special needs students
- 30. A company builds a mental health app for employees only
- 31. A startup introduces a completely new wearable that detects emotions
- 32. A founder replicates a global business model but adapts it to local culture

LU1 – Types of Entrepreneurs

Build your Start-Up Identity

Instructions:

1. Each pair will randomly select the type of entrepreneur
 - Innovative
 - Imitative
 - Social
 - Intrapreneur
2. Each pair must design a product based on the type of entrepreneur they had randomly selected and they must include:
 - Product name
 - Target users
 - Problem solved
 - Key features
 - Why it fits their entrepreneur type
3. The pair then select randomly from the following constraints
 - “Budget under \$1,000”
 - “Target elderly users”
 - “Must be eco-friendly”
 - “Must use AI”
4. The pair will then pitch their start-up identity using the given template. Each pair will be given 3-5 minutes and must clearly show their entrepreneurship type